

Camping Chair — Buying Report (June 2026)

For: Mix of car-camping / festivals / garden + occasional carrying. **Comfort is the #1 priority.** **Build:** Tall / larger — needs a **tall backrest** and **120kg+ capacity** (real margin). **Wanted features:** reclining · padded headrest · footrest · cup holder/storage · padding/insulation. **Budget:** max **£200**.

Research method: 5 parallel web-research agents (comfort roundups, packable-premium chairs, heavy-duty tall recliners, feature-by-feature comparison, live UK pricing). Prices accessed **22 June 2026** — re-confirm at checkout.

The honest headline

No single chair under £200 ticks all five features (recline + headrest + footrest + cup holder + padding) and clears 120kg with margin. The market splits into two camps:

- **Heavy-duty padded recliners** (Vango / Outwell / Kampa) — recline + headrest + padding + footrest accessory + 180–200kg capacity, but **5–7kg and bulkier**. ← Best fit for *your* brief (comfort-first, tall, heavy-duty).
- **Packable premium** (Helinox / Nemo) — tall back, ultralight (1–3kg), but **no footrest, little/no padding**, and recline is fixed or absent.

Since you ranked **comfort + tall + heavy-duty above portability**, my recommendations lean to the first camp, and I show how to add the one or two missing pieces (a footrest accessory / seat pad) cheaply.

My pick for you: Vango Hampton Grande DLX (~£100)

The best all-round match to your brief, with real headroom on capacity:

Spec	Detail
Capacity	180 kg (28 st) — genuine margin for a larger user
Back height	119 cm (tall) · extra-wide 59 cm seat
Recline	7 adjustable positions (upright → lounger)
Headrest	Adjustable cushion (doubles as headrest / lumbar)
Padding	Padded seat + back , DuoWeave fabric, steel frame
Footrest	Optional matching footrest fits all Hampton chairs
Weight	~6.7 kg (fine for car + short carries)
Price	~£100 (Vango UK)

Why it wins: highest realistic capacity here *with* a tall, extra-wide padded seat, proper multi-position recline, headrest, and a footrest you can bolt on. At £100 it leaves budget for the footrest accessory and still comes in well under £200. **Watch-outs:** ~6.7 kg and bulkier than a packable; **frequently out of stock on Vango UK** — if so, the **Hampton DLX (£95, 140kg)** is the near-identical in-stock fallback (just less capacity margin).

The three tiers

Budget — Outwell Catamarca Lounger · ~£54–80

The most features for the money — and the only sub-£100 chair with a genuine built-in footrest.

Feature	Has it?
Recline	dining → lounger
Headrest	high back, head support in lounge position
Footrest	built-in, auto-rises as you lean back
Cup holder	mesh holder
Padding	slings fabric (add an insulating seat pad)
Capacity / weight	125 kg · ~6 kg

Best for: ticking the most boxes cheaply. It's the only chair found with an *integrated* footrest + recline + cup holder + high back. Add a £10–15 fleece/insulated seat pad and you effectively get all five for under £80. **Don't confuse** the **Lounger** (footrest + recline, ~£54–80) with the plain **Catamarca / Catamarca XL armchairs** (£25/£43, cup holders but **no recline/footrest**).

Mid — Vango Hampton Grande DLX · ~£100 *top pick (details above)*

Alternative at this tier — Outwell Grand Canyon XL · ~£110 (if you want max capacity & height):

Spec	Detail
Capacity	200 kg (highest in budget)
Back height	up to 136 cm reclined (tallest here)
Recline	7 positions · headrest adjustable + removable
Padding	quick-dry foam + 3D mesh (breathable, not warm)
Footrest	none (add a clip-on)
Weight / price	6.1 kg · ~£110

Pick the **Grande DLX** for the wide padded seat + footrest option; pick the **Grand Canyon XL** for the highest capacity (200kg), tallest reclined back and lighter weight, if you don't mind breathable-mesh (cooler) padding and no footrest.

Best under £200 — two routes (pick by what you value)

Route A — plushest padding + highest capacity: Outwell Acadia · £165

Feature	Has it?
Recline	lockable slide positions (back 100–114 cm)
Headrest	adjustable + removable
Cup holder	side table with holder
Padding	quick-dry 3D mesh padding
Footrest	(add a clip-on)
Capacity / weight	150 kg · 8.4 kg

Best for: the most cushioned, "armchair" feel with the highest weight rating of the recliners, plus a side table + cup holder. Heaviest option — car-camping comfort.

Route B — comfort + occasional carry: Nemo Stargaze EVO-X · ~£166

Feature	Has it?
Recline	swinging auto-recline (finds your angle hands-free)
Headrest	adjustable padded headrest
Cup holder	two integrated holders
Padding	cool monofilament mesh (not insulating)
Footrest	
Capacity / weight	136 kg · 2.86 kg (far lighter)

Best for: the standout *comfort experience* ("part recliner, part hammock, part rocker") while staying light enough to carry — the best fit for your "mix of both" use. Downsides: mesh is the opposite of warm (poor cold-weather), no footrest.

Lighter still: **Helinox Sunset (£150, 145kg, 1.6kg)** — tall back + headrest flap, the most packable premium option, but **fixed recline, no footrest, no padding**.

Feature scorecard (at a glance)

Chair	Price	Capacity	Recline	Headrest	Footrest	Cup holder	Padding	Weight
Outwell Catamarca Lounger	£54–80	125 kg			built-in			6 kg
Vango Hampton Grande DLX	~£100	180 kg	7-pos		accessory			6.7 kg
	~£110	200 kg						6.1 kg

Chair	Price	Capacity	Recline	Headrest	Footrest	Cup holder	Padding	Weight
Outwell Grand Canyon XL			7-pos	removable			mesh	
Outwell Acadia	£165	150 kg		removable				8.4 kg
Nemo Stargaze EVO-X	~£166	136 kg	swing				mesh	2.86 kg
Helinox Sunset	£150	145 kg	fixed	flap				1.6 kg

= available as a separate accessory.

Complete-the-setup accessories (to fill the gaps)

- **Footrest:** Vango Hampton footrest / Kampa Dometic Roma footrest (fits their recliners) — check price at purchase. Or a universal clip-on leg rest (Decathlon Quechua leg rest is ~£17 and fits Quechua chairs).
- **Padding/warmth:** a fleece or insulated **seat pad** (£10–15) turns a mesh/sling chair into a year-round one — the cheapest way to add the "insulation" box to the Catamarca Lounger or Grand Canyon XL.
- **Cup holder/storage:** clip-on cup holders are ~£5–8 if your chosen chair lacks one (Vango Hampton).

What to avoid / size-up warnings

- **Quechua reclining + leg rest combo (~£57)** — cheapest way to get recline + headrest + footrest + padding together, **but only 110kg capacity** (model-dependent; some 150kg). Below your 120kg floor on the base model — verify the exact SKU's rating.
- **Standard Helinox Chair One** — only ~74cm (a *low* back), not the tall chair you want. If going Helinox, choose **Sunset / Savanna / Chair One XL / Chair Two**.
- **Nemo Moonlite Reclining** — reclines and packs to 500g, but **only ~113kg** — fails your capacity need.
- **Alpkit Vagabond Highback / Robens Observer (~£75–90)** — lovely lightweight tall-backs, but **capacity caps at exactly 120kg** (no margin). Only if you're comfortably under it.
- **Front Runner Expander / Outdoor Revolution High Back XL** — 115kg / 100kg respectively; too low.
- **GCI / REI chairs** — GCI has no UK store (only the Rocker XL + Side-Table on Amazon UK); REI doesn't ship to the UK. Mostly skip.

Running/ownership notes

- Steel-framed padded recliners (Vango/Outwell/Kampa) are the most durable for heavy, repeated use and best for a larger user — expect 5–8kg and a bag the size of a folded camp table.

- Aluminium packables (Helinox/Nemo) cost more per kg of comfort but win massively on carry weight and packed size.
 - Look for **3-year warranties** (Kampa Dometic Modena range) as a longevity signal.
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Decision shortcut

- **Best all-round for your brief (comfort + tall + heavy-duty + footrest option)** → Vango Hampton Grande DLX (~£100) (or Hampton DLX £95 if out of stock).
 - **Most features for least money (built-in footrest!)** → Outwell Catamarca Lounger (~£54–80) + a seat pad.
 - **Plushest, highest-capacity armchair feel** → Outwell Acadia (£165, 150kg).
 - **Best comfort that you can still carry** → Nemo Stargaze EVO-X (~£166, 2.86kg).
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Caveats / confidence

- Prices fluctuate and several caravan/Kampa retailers don't expose live prices to automated checks — **confirm at checkout**.
- Highest-confidence (read direct from retailer page): Helinox Sunset £149.95 / Savanna £199.95, Vango Hampton DLX £95 / Grande DLX £100, Outwell Catamarca £25 / XL £43 / Ramsgate £80, Nemo Stargaze Luxury £299 / Moonlite £149.99.
- **Verify before buying:** the exact capacity rating of the Quechua/Kampa Modena SKU (sources differ 120–150kg); that you're buying the Catamarca **Lounger** (footrest) not the plain armchair; and current stock on the Vango Hampton Grande DLX.

Key sources

- Vango Hampton DLX / Grande DLX: vango.co.uk/hampton-dlx-chair · [/hampton-grande-dlx-chair](https://vango.co.uk/hampton-grande-dlx-chair)
- Outwell Catamarca Lounger / Grand Canyon XL / Acadia: outwell.com/en-gb/ecommerce/camping-furniture · purelyoutdoors.co.uk · millets.co.uk
- Nemo Stargaze EVO-X: nemoequipment.com/products/stargaze-reclining-camp-chair · valleyandpeak.co.uk
- Helinox Sunset/Savanna: helinox.co.uk/products/sunset-chair · [/savanna-chair](https://helinox.co.uk/products/savanna-chair)
- Roundups: livefortheoutdoors.com/camping/accessories/best-camping-chairs · outdoorsmagic.com/article/best-camping-chairs